

Problem Statement

Evaluate the limit from the image "dailyintegral-limit-limit-1x1-2026-07-25.jpg":

$$L = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_0^{\ln(n)} \frac{2 - e^x - e^{-nx}}{e^x - 1} dx$$

Detailed Solution

To evaluate this limit, we decompose the integrand algebraically, apply a variable substitution to simplify the resulting fraction, and utilize the asymptotic properties of the harmonic numbers.

Step 1: Algebraic Manipulation of the Integrand

We begin by rewriting the numerator of the integrand to separate the exponential terms:

$$\frac{2 - e^x - e^{-nx}}{e^x - 1} = \frac{(1 - e^x) + (1 - e^{-nx})}{e^x - 1} = -1 + \frac{1 - e^{-nx}}{e^x - 1}$$

Substituting this identity back into our definite integral allows us to split it into two simpler integrals:

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^{\ln(n)} \frac{2 - e^x - e^{-nx}}{e^x - 1} dx &= \int_0^{\ln(n)} (-1) dx + \int_0^{\ln(n)} \frac{1 - e^{-nx}}{e^x - 1} dx \\ &= -\ln(n) + \int_0^{\ln(n)} \frac{1 - e^{-nx}}{e^x - 1} dx \end{aligned}$$

Step 2: Substitution and Integration

Let I_n denote the second integral:

$$I_n = \int_0^{\ln(n)} \frac{1 - e^{-nx}}{e^x - 1} dx$$

We apply the substitution $u = e^{-x}$, which implies $x = -\ln(u)$ and $dx = -\frac{1}{u} du$. The limits of integration transform as follows:

- When $x = 0$, $u = e^0 = 1$.
- When $x = \ln(n)$, $u = e^{-\ln(n)} = \frac{1}{n}$.

The denominator can be expressed in terms of u as:

$$e^x - 1 = \frac{1}{u} - 1 = \frac{1 - u}{u}$$

Substituting these into I_n , we obtain:

$$I_n = \int_1^{1/n} \frac{1-u^n}{\frac{1-u}{u}} \left(-\frac{1}{u} du \right) = \int_{1/n}^1 \frac{1-u^n}{1-u} du$$

Using the standard finite geometric series identity $\frac{1-u^n}{1-u} = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} u^k$, we can integrate term by term:

$$\begin{aligned} I_n &= \int_{1/n}^1 \left(\sum_{k=0}^{n-1} u^k \right) du = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \int_{1/n}^1 u^k du \\ &= \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \left[\frac{u^{k+1}}{k+1} \right]_{1/n}^1 = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \frac{1}{k+1} \left(1 - \frac{1}{n^{k+1}} \right) \end{aligned}$$

Shifting the index of summation by setting $m = k + 1$, we get:

$$I_n = \sum_{m=1}^n \frac{1}{m} - \sum_{m=1}^n \frac{1}{mn^m}$$

Step 3: Connection to Harmonic Numbers

Recall that the n -th harmonic number is defined as $H_n = \sum_{m=1}^n \frac{1}{m}$. Combining this with our result from Step 1, the full definite integral before taking the limit is:

$$\int_0^{\ln(n)} \frac{2 - e^x - e^{-nx}}{e^x - 1} dx = H_n - \ln(n) - \sum_{m=1}^n \frac{1}{mn^m}$$

Step 4: Asymptotic Evaluation and Limit

Now, we evaluate the limit as $n \rightarrow \infty$:

$$L = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \left(H_n - \ln(n) - \sum_{m=1}^n \frac{1}{mn^m} \right)$$

We analyze the convergence of the two components independently:

1. By definition, the asymptotic difference between the harmonic number H_n and the natural logarithm $\ln(n)$ converges to the Euler-Mascheroni constant, γ :

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} (H_n - \ln(n)) = \gamma \approx 0.5772156649 \dots$$

2. For the remaining summation, we can bound it above by an infinite geometric series for all $n \geq 2$:

$$0 < \sum_{m=1}^n \frac{1}{mn^m} \leq \sum_{m=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{n^m} = \frac{\frac{1}{n}}{1 - \frac{1}{n}} = \frac{1}{n-1}$$

By the Squeeze Theorem, since $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{n-1} = 0$, we have:

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \sum_{m=1}^n \frac{1}{mn^m} = 0$$

Combining these evaluations yields the final value of the limit:

$$L = \gamma - 0 = \gamma$$

Final Answer:

$$\gamma$$